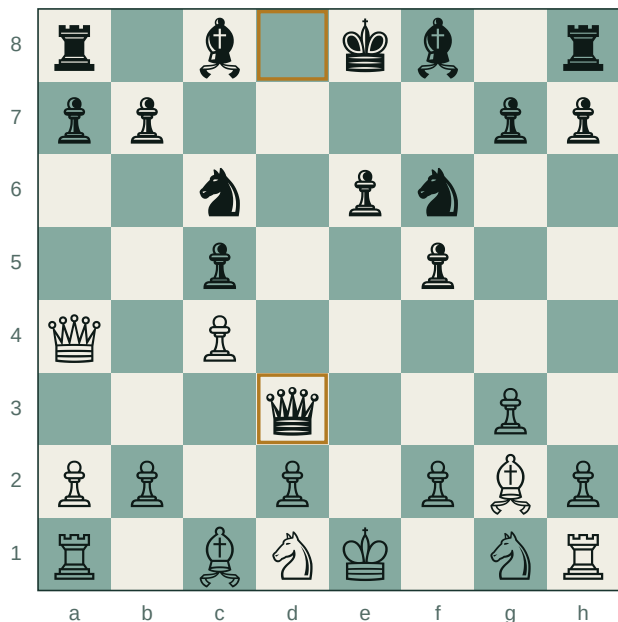


Exposed-king tactics: White, move 10

Exposed-king tactics

White to move



Previous move: 9...Qxd3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

10. Bxc6+ bxc6 11. Qxc6+ Qd7 12. Qxa8

10.Bxc6+ Check restricts Black to 7 legal replies here. The move also takes the knight on c6. Recorded reply: **10...bxc6**.

11.Qxc6+ Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. From c6 it attacks king on e8, rook on a8 and bishop on c8. Recorded reply: **11...Qd7**.

12.Qxa8 The queen captures the rook on a8.

At the end, nominal material is White 35 / Black 29 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from +0 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on e8. Absolute pin: knight on c6.